

MOBL-11: Dashboards & Alerting

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Overview

Effective mobile monitoring requires more than raw telemetry -- you need dashboards that surface the right KPIs at a glance and alerts that notify the right people when something goes wrong. This notebook covers designing mobile KPI dashboards with tiles for crash-free rate, session volume, and performance trends; setting up crash rate monitoring with timeseries visualizations; tracking app performance metrics across user actions; and configuring alerts using Dynatrace Intelligence anomaly detection and metric events. The goal is to move from reactive troubleshooting to proactive mobile observability.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Dynatrace Environment	SaaS with Grail enabled
Permissions	<code>rum.read</code> , <code>events.read</code> , <code>bizevents.read</code> , <code>metrics.read</code>
Dashboard Permissions	<code>document:documents:write</code> for creating and editing dashboards
Workflow Permissions	<code>automation:workflows:write</code> for configuring alert-triggered workflows
Mobile App	At least one mobile application with active sessions and crash data
Prior Knowledge	Familiarity with MOBL-01 through MOBL-10 recommended

1. Mobile KPI Dashboard Design

A well-designed mobile dashboard answers the question "Is our mobile app healthy right now?" at a glance. Rather than cramming every metric onto a single screen, organize tiles by purpose: health indicators at the top, trends in the middle, and drill-down tables at the bottom.



Recommended Dashboard Layout

Tile	Type	Purpose
Crash-Free Rate	Single value	Overall app health indicator -- percentage of sessions without crashes
Session Volume	Timeseries	Usage trends over time to spot adoption changes or drops
Top Crashes	Table	Prioritize fixes by crash frequency and affected user count
Action Duration	Timeseries	Performance monitoring for key user actions (load, tap, swipe)
OS Distribution	Pie/Donut	Platform breakdown to allocate testing and development resources
Error Rate	Timeseries	Error monitoring to catch regressions before they become crashes

Design Principles

- **Top row: health at a glance** -- Use single-value tiles with color thresholds (green/yellow/red) for crash-free rate, active sessions, and error rate
- **Middle row: trends** -- Timeseries charts for session volume, action duration, and error trends over the last 7 days
- **Bottom row: drill-down** -- Tables for top crashes, slowest user actions, and most affected app versions
- **Use variables** -- Add a dashboard variable for `useraction.application` so stakeholders can filter to their specific app
- **Time range selector** -- Always include a time range control defaulting to the last 24 hours, with presets for 1h, 6h, 24h, 7d

2. Crash Rate Monitoring

Crash rate is the most critical mobile KPI. App store algorithms use crash rate to determine visibility and ranking, and users who experience crashes are significantly more likely to uninstall. A crash-free rate below 99% typically indicates a serious quality problem.

The following query builds a daily timeseries showing both total event volume and crash event volume, which you can use to calculate crash rate as a derived metric in your dashboard.

```
// Crash rate timeseries by application
fetch bizevents, from:-7d
| filter event.provider == "www.dynatrace.com/mobile"
| fieldsAdd is_crash = if(event.type == "com.dynatrace.crash", then:1, else:0)
| makeTimeseries {total_events = count(), crash_events = sum(is_crash)},
interval:1d
```

Interpreting the Results

This query produces two timeseries arrays: `total_events` (all mobile business events) and `crash_events` (only crashes). To calculate the crash rate percentage on a dashboard tile, divide crash events by total events and multiply by 100. A healthy app should maintain a crash rate below 1%.

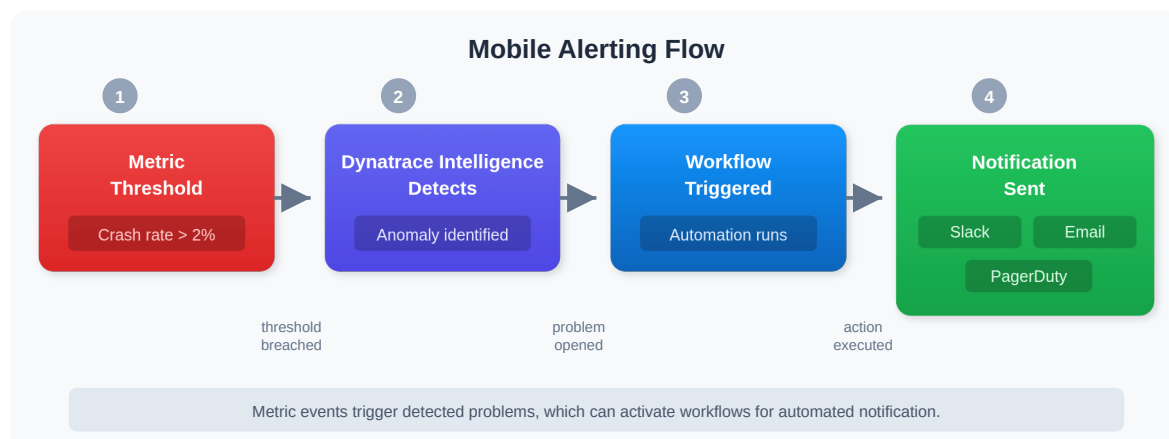
Crash-Free Rate	Health Status	Action
> 99.5%	Excellent	Monitor normally
99.0% - 99.5%	Acceptable	Review top crash groups
98.0% - 99.0%	Degraded	Investigate and prioritize fixes
< 98.0%	Critical	Immediate action required

Tip: Break crash rate down by app version using `by:{app.version}` to identify whether a specific release introduced a regression.

3. App Performance Metrics

Beyond crashes, performance directly impacts user engagement. Slow app launches, sluggish screen transitions, and unresponsive taps all contribute to poor user experience and eventual churn. Track these metrics alongside crash data to get a complete picture of mobile app health.

The alerting flow for mobile performance follows a standard pattern from metric detection through notification:



Key Performance Indicators

Metric	Good	Warning	Critical
App Launch Time	< 2 seconds	2-5 seconds	> 5 seconds
Action Duration	< 1 second	1-3 seconds	> 3 seconds
HTTP Error Rate	< 1%	1-5%	> 5%
Crash-Free Rate	> 99.5%	98-99.5%	< 98%

```
// Session volume timeseries (hourly)
fetch bizevents, from:-7d
| filter event.provider == "www.dynatrace.com/mobile"
| filter isNotNull(dt.rum.session.id)
| makeTimeseries session_count = countDistinct(dt.rum.session.id), interval:1h
```

This query counts the number of distinct sessions per hour over the past 7 days. Use it as a dashboard tile to spot usage patterns (peak hours, weekday vs weekend) and detect sudden drops that may indicate an outage or broken update.

4. Session Volume Trends

User action duration measures how long it takes for specific interactions to complete -- tapping a button, loading a screen, or submitting a form. Tracking these durations over time reveals performance regressions introduced by new releases or backend changes.

```
// User action duration trend by type
fetch bizevents, from:-24h
| filter event.provider == "www.dynatrace.com/mobile"
| filter isNotNull(useraction.duration)
| makeTimeseries avg_duration = avg(useraction.duration), by:
{useraction.type}, interval:1h
```

Reading the Duration Chart

The timeseries above breaks down average action duration by type (e.g., `Load`, `Tap`, `Swipe`, `Custom`). Look for:

- **Gradual increases** -- May indicate backend degradation or growing payload sizes
- **Sudden spikes** -- Often correlated with a new app release or backend deployment
- **Platform differences** -- Compare iOS vs Android by adding `by:{os.type}` to identify platform-specific bottlenecks

Note: Action durations are captured in milliseconds. Divide by 1000 if you prefer to display values in seconds on your dashboard.

5. Metric Alerts for Mobile

Dashboards are for humans looking at screens. Alerts are for ensuring problems are noticed even when nobody is watching. Dynatrace supports two complementary alerting mechanisms for mobile KPIs:

1. **Dynatrace Intelligence Anomaly Detection** -- Automatically detects deviations from baseline behavior without manual threshold configuration. Best for metrics with natural variance (session volume, action duration).
2. **Metric Events (Custom Alerts)** -- Manually defined thresholds that fire when a metric crosses a specific boundary. Best for hard limits (crash rate > X, error rate > Y).

Recommended Alert Configuration

Alert	Metric/Query	Threshold	Severity
High Crash Rate	Crash count per hour	> 10 crashes in a sliding 1-hour window	Critical
Session Drop	Session count drop	< 50% of the rolling 7-day baseline	Warning
Slow App Launch	App start duration	> 5 seconds average over 15 minutes	Warning
High Error Rate	HTTP 5xx from mobile	> 5% of requests returning server errors	Critical

Creating a Metric Event

Prefer a Davis anomaly detector for new mobile alerting. The metric-event procedure below is the classic surface — `builtin:anomaly-detection.metric-events` is flagged **Blocked at upgrade**, so alerts built here have to be recreated as DQL-based detectors (`builtin:davis.anomaly-detectors`) when the tenant moves to the latest Dynatrace. Existing metric events keep working until then. Note also that Dynatrace's transformation path converts metric *selectors* only — a **Type: Metric key** event like the example below, which is a static threshold on a single key, has no automated conversion and must be rebuilt by hand. See ALERT-02 for choosing between mechanisms.

To create a custom alert (metric event) in Dynatrace:

1. Navigate to **Settings > Anomaly Detection > Metric Events**
2. Click **Add metric event**
3. Configure the event:

```
# Example: High crash rate alert
Summary: Mobile crash rate exceeds threshold
Type: Metric key
Metric key: dt.rum.mobile.crash.count # (or use a DQL-based metric)
Aggregation: Count
Entity filter: Mobile application
Model type: Static threshold
Threshold: 10
Alert condition: Above
Sliding window: 1 hour
Dealerting samples: 3
Severity: Critical
```

Dynatrace Intelligence vs Static Thresholds

Approach	Best For	Limitations
Dynatrace Intelligence	Metrics with seasonal patterns, automatically adapts to baselines	May miss gradual degradation; requires learning period
Static Threshold	Hard business limits (SLAs, crash budgets)	Must be manually tuned; doesn't adapt to growth
Both Combined	Maximum coverage -- Dynatrace Intelligence catches anomalies, static thresholds enforce SLAs	More alerts to manage

Tip: Start with Dynatrace Intelligence for performance metrics (it adapts to your app's normal patterns) and add static thresholds only for KPIs with hard business requirements like crash-free rate SLAs.

6. Detected Problem Correlation

When Dynatrace Intelligence detects an anomaly affecting a mobile application, it creates a problem that can be correlated with the mobile telemetry you see on dashboards. The following query retrieves recent detected problems that impact mobile device applications, helping you bridge the gap between infrastructure-level detection and user-facing impact.


```
// detected problems affecting mobile applications
fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-7d
| expand affected_entity_ids
| filter contains(toString(affected_entity_ids), "MOBILE_APPLICATION")
| fields timestamp, display_id, event.name, event.status, affected_entity_ids
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 20
```

Correlating Problems with Mobile Metrics

When you identify a detected problem affecting a mobile application, overlay the problem time range on your dashboard timeseries to see:

- **Did crash rate spike during the problem window?** -- If yes, the root cause likely caused crashes, not just slowdowns
- **Did session volume drop?** -- A sudden drop in sessions during a problem may indicate users are unable to launch the app
- **Did action duration increase?** -- Performance degradation detected by Dynatrace Intelligence should correlate with user-facing slowness

Problem Workflow Integration

Connect detected problems to your notification channels so the mobile team is alerted immediately:

```
# Workflow trigger for mobile-specific problems
trigger:
  type: davis-problem
  config:
    entityTagsMatch: any
    entityTags:
      - key: app-type
        value: mobile

tasks:
  - name: notify_mobile_team
    type: dynatrace.slack:send-message
    input:
      connection: slack-mobile-alerts
      channel: "#mobile-incidents"
      message: |
        :rotating_light: Mobile Problem Detected
        Problem: {{ event()['title'] }}
        Severity: {{ event()['severity'] }}
        Affected: {{ event()['affected_entity_ids'] | join(', ') }}
```

7. Executive Summary Tiles

Executive stakeholders need a single table that answers: "How are our mobile apps doing?" The following query produces a summary row per application with the key metrics that matter most -- total actions, unique sessions, crash count, and actions per session (an engagement indicator).

```
// Executive summary -- key metrics per mobile app
fetch bizevents, from:-24h
| filter event.provider == "www.dynatrace.com/mobile"
| summarize {total_actions = count(), unique_sessions =
countDistinct(dt.rum.session.id), crash_count = countIf(event.type ==
"com.dynatrace.crash")}, by:{useraction.application}
| fieldsAdd actions_per_session = toDouble(total_actions) /
toDouble(unique_sessions)
| sort total_actions desc
| limit 10
```

Building the Executive Dashboard

Use the query above as a table tile on your dashboard. Add conditional formatting to highlight:

- **Crash count > 0** in red to draw attention to apps with active stability issues
- **Actions per session < 3** in yellow to flag apps with low user engagement
- **Unique sessions** trending down week-over-week as a leading indicator of user attrition

Dashboard Sharing

Audience	Dashboard Focus	Refresh Interval
Mobile Developers	Crash details, stack traces, action performance	5 minutes
QA Team	Crash-free rate by version, error trends	15 minutes
Product Managers	Session volume, engagement, feature adoption	1 hour
Executives	Summary KPIs, crash-free rate, active users	Daily snapshot

Tip: Use Dynatrace dashboard sharing to send scheduled PDF snapshots to stakeholders who do not log into Dynatrace directly.

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

- **Dashboard design principles** -- Organize tiles by purpose (health indicators at top, trends in middle, drill-down tables at bottom) with application-level filtering
- **Crash rate monitoring** -- Build a timeseries comparing total events to crash events, and interpret crash-free rate thresholds
- **App performance metrics** -- Track session volume and user action duration to detect regressions and correlate with backend changes
- **Session volume trends** -- Identify usage patterns, peak hours, and sudden drops that may indicate outages

- **Metric alerts** -- Configure Dynatrace Intelligence anomaly detection for adaptive baselines and static thresholds for hard SLA limits
 - **detected problem correlation** -- Query problems affecting mobile applications and overlay them with dashboard timeseries
 - **Executive summary tiles** -- Build single-table summaries with total actions, unique sessions, crash count, and engagement metrics
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Next Steps

Continue to **MOBL-12** to explore:

- Advanced mobile analytics and business impact analysis
 - Funnel analysis for mobile conversion tracking
 - Combining mobile telemetry with business events for end-to-end visibility
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References

- [Dynatrace Dashboards](#)
 - [Metric Events for Alerting](#)
 - [Mobile App Monitoring](#)
 - [Dynatrace Intelligence Problems](#)
 - [Workflows for Alerting](#)
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